

Visual Studio Code - Installation & Setup

A complete guide to prepare the environment, install, configure, validate and perform the first functional use of the tool.

Manual objective

This manual guides you through the complete installation and setup process, from preparing the environment to final validation. Follow the steps in order and use the checks throughout the guide to confirm that each configuration was completed correctly.

Official references

<https://code.visualstudio.com/download>

What is it?

VS Code is a code editor with extensions, integrated terminal, debugging, Git and multi-language support.

Official site and documentation

Use the official Visual Studio Code source as the primary reference: <https://code.visualstudio.com/download>. Official documentation should be the first source for installation, supported versions, syntax changes and new features.

Installation

Download from the official site and open the project folder rather than isolated files.

QA extensions

Install only the extensions you need, such as support for Python, languages, linting and your framework tools. Evaluate the publisher, permissions and source.

Integrated terminal

VS Code can host PowerShell, CMD, Git Bash and other shells. VS Code itself is not PowerShell.

Debugging

Breakpoints, variables, call stack and logs help investigate automation beyond print statements.

Integrated Git

VS Code exposes diffs and Git status, but understanding the underlying concepts remains important.

How to start safely

Start from the official Visual Studio Code site and documentation. Confirm prerequisites, supported versions, operating system and required permissions. Learn in a controlled environment before using it in a critical workflow.

First QA-oriented use

Pick one small, verifiable task in Visual Studio Code, configure only what is necessary, run a simple example and confirm the outcome. Repeat with different data or conditions before adding abstractions.

Using it in a real project

Define where Visual Studio Code fits, who owns configuration, how credentials and data are handled and how results are shared. Integrate it into the team workflow instead of creating an isolated activity.

Adoption good practices

Standardize versions and configuration, document important decisions, keep secrets out of code and preserve reproducible examples. Reassess whether Visual Studio Code still delivers value as the product evolves.

Common issues and troubleshooting

When Visual Studio Code fails, verify versions, dependencies, permissions, connectivity, data and environment before assuming a product defect. Preserve the original error and reduce the issue to the smallest reproducible case.